

GA-ST-02

Safeguarding & Active Supervision

The duty to remain attentive, prevent harm, respond to concerns, and transfer responsibility safely.

APPLIES TO

Gardner Academy employees and relevant staff

AUTHORITY

Gardner Academy staff standard

01 Policy statement

The welfare of children is the first consideration in every Gardner decision. All staff share responsibility for creating a safe environment, actively supervising students, and reporting concerns without delay.

02 Active supervision

Active supervision requires with-it-ness: continuous awareness of where students are, what they are doing, how the environment is changing, and where support or intervention may be needed.

Staff must:

- Position themselves so students can be seen and heard.
- Spread out across supervision areas instead of gathering for casual conversation.
- Maintain with-it-ness by scanning, listening, moving through the area, anticipating risks, and responding before a situation escalates.
- Follow the assigned supervision rotation and remain at the designated post until the next responsible staff member has arrived and accepted the handover.
- Remain alert to entrances, exits, hidden areas, equipment, and changing risks.
- Never leave students unattended or assume another adult has taken responsibility.
- Use a clear verbal handover before leaving a group, duty, or activity.
- Put a child asking for help ahead of non-urgent adult conversation or personal tasks.

03 A concern or disclosure

Listen calmly, take the child seriously, do not promise secrecy, ask only enough to understand the immediate concern, and report it promptly through the designated safeguarding route. Record the child's words and observable facts as accurately as possible.

04 Emergency response

Protect immediate safety, summon appropriate help, follow the school emergency procedure, and notify management. Staff must not conduct their own investigation, confront an alleged person, or circulate details beyond those who need to know.

05 Rotations and changes

Staff must check the current supervision rotation, know their assigned area and handover person, and promptly clarify any gap or conflict. An employee who is absent, delayed, moved to another duty, or unable to cover an assigned area must notify the designated person before the rotation begins. Staff must not informally abandon or swap supervision duties without an approved replacement and clear handover.